

to \$50 or \$60. If your grocery bill comes to \$20, for example, say “yes” when the cashier asks if you want cash back. The money he or she gives you from the till is generally fee-free—a better deal than going to an ATM.

- **Keep your ATM receipts.** Hold on to those little slips until you can check them against your online statement to make sure the bank hasn’t made an error in recording your transaction.

↓ **WHEN TO GO INTERNET-ONLY**

You may choose to go with an account that’s offered only online, or an **Internet bank account**. This could mean that your bank has few or no brick and mortar branches, or it may mean that you’ve signed up for an online-only account at a traditional bank. Either way, Internet bank accounts have become extremely popular recently, largely because they pay higher interest on savings accounts. Since the costs for that bank are so much lower than those of a brick and mortar bank (branches, tellers, ATMs) it can pass on these savings to you in the form of higher interest.

You’ll most likely get an ATM card for cash withdrawals and debit card purchases. Some banks will offer paper checks as well or will enable you to make online payments. There are some drawbacks, however. (For example, you may not be able to communicate with anyone at the bank in person.) If you’re thinking about signing up for an Internet bank account, here are some things to consider:

- **What kinds of deposits will you be making?** If most are from your paycheck, no problem: Sign up for direct deposit. But many Internet banks don’t have a wide ATM network, which means that in order to make most any other kind of deposit, you’ll have to *mail* it to the bank. This could be a major problem if you need to get a check into your account right away or if you’re paid in cash. Some Internet banks are affiliated with brick and mortar banks and therefore have